

Fall 2025
Instructor: Robin Johnson
CRC Main Campus
Studio: A602
Class Hours: T/Th 9:00-11:10 am
Office hours: M: 11:10am-1:00pm
By appointment: Th: 11:30-1:40pm

SYLLABUS ART 327: PAINTING I

Course Description:

This is an introduction to the tools, materials, and techniques of painting. Coursework includes exercises in light and color theory, description of form, color and spatial development, and composition. In-person or virtual field trips that might require entrance fees may occur for this course. We will explore objective and non-objective forms and apply both historical and contemporary methods in our approaches.

Course Information:

Units: 3

Hours: 36 hours LEC; 54 hours LAB

72 hours out-of-class work, for a total of 162 student learning hours.

Prerequisite: None.

Advisory: ART 300

Lab fees:

This course has a required lab fee of \$30. A supply list will be provided at the beginning of the course, which each student will be responsible for obtaining (the lab fee does not cover the supply list). Students are REQUIRED to have all materials needed in class and for each project at the designated time. If you do not have the appropriate materials on the assigned date you will be marked unprepared-no exception. Please see instructor with any further questions regarding the supply list.

Required Text/Reading Resources:

Handouts and various reading materials will be provided throughout the semester.

Recommended textbook:

•Jennings, Simon (2014) *The Complete Artist's Manual: The Definitive Guide to Painting and Drawing*, Chronicle Books. ISBN: 1452127166

•Juliette Aristides (2016). *Lessons in Classical Painting: Essential Techniques from Inside the Atelier*. London: Watson-Guption. [ISBN: 978-1607747895]

Course Objectives/Student outcomes:

- 1) Build physical skills/dexterity within the painting discipline.
 - Evaluate and judge the correlation between painting supports, surface preparation, paint application and techniques for opaque and transparent painting medium.
 - Create and utilize the color wheel to make effective decisions for color harmony, color schemes, color temperature, and tone.
 - Utilize color mixing and blending to gain understanding of neutralized and saturated color, color temperature, and value.
- 2) Identify and analyze the major aspects of painting: form, spatial development, composition, and expression
 - Assess the effects of color in the light areas and in the shadow areas of a composition.
 - Understand the effect of color in value, contrast, saturation, and temperature on forms and spatial development.
- 3) Utilize analytical skills and develop a conceptual framework for the future.
 - Integrate concept, process and execution in order to create compositions with a variety of subjects including still life, landscape and figure.
- 4) Acquire the ability to critique one's work and the work of classmates through comparison, contrast, and formal analysis.
- 5) Practice proper care, cleaning, safety, and maintenance of all materials used in the painting process.

Course Content:

- 1) In-depth examination of materials, tools and techniques of painting
- 2) Color theory and application
- 3) Light theory and application to painting
- 4) Composition, variation of subject matter in painting and stylistic approaches to painting

- 5) Historical and cultural survey of painting, integrated with subject matter and paint techniques
- 6) Presentation: prepping, framing, and conservation
- 7) Portfolio review

Controversial Content:

There may be occasion where legitimate class discussions, media, or resources deal with issues, images, or symbols that may be viewed as controversial. This is unavoidable in a college level art course which covers artistic expression and historical themes. Students should be aware that some class materials might be perceived as offensive to one's sensibilities.

Course Format and Methods of Instruction:

The majority of course studio time will be spent painting. Paintings will either be based on direct observation or they will be exercises designed to introduce basic formal concepts and techniques. Most instruction will occur on a one-on-one basis between the student and the instructor. In addition there will be lectures, demonstrations and class critiques. Student workload expectations for all 3 unit Studio courses in painting include devoted time in the studio and additional outside studio work, reading, or other assignments per week. Students should recognize that studio projects often take longer than anticipated and that reworking and revising is part of the creative process and a necessity for producing high quality works. If you need help managing your time commitments and studio workload please see your professor.

- 1) Regular class assignments and exercises to be completed in class. All assignments completed in class will be reviewed for a letter grade.
- 2) Regular assignments due on a weekly or bi-weekly basis to be completed outside of class. All work completed outside of class will be reviewed for a letter grade.
- 3) Master Artist assignment: Discussed and chosen by the student from provided lecture.
- 4) Attendance to one out of class art lecture, a museum/gallery visit related to class content, or a submission to an exhibition for consideration will be accepted for extra-credit. Must be accompanied by a ticket stub or receipt, and a 1-pg typed review of the show. Prior discussion with instructor is mandatory. (Note, this does not count towards missed class days)

Course Requirements:

- 1) Thoughtful and timely completion and submission of all assignments.
- 2) Active participation in class critiques, class discussions, assignments.
- 3) Willingness to independently explore ideas and techniques in order to further one's artistic development.
- 4) Dedication and commitment to the learning process, manifested through quality work, punctuality, and regular attendance.
- 5) Respect for the art studio policies and for the safety of the community.
- 6) It is the student's responsibility to understand the course material being taught and/or provided, and should make reasonable accommodations prior to each class should they need outside assistance translating material allowing for full class participation daily.
- 7) It is the responsibility of the student to communicate with the instructor.

Studio Policy/Professionalism:

Students are responsible for developing a professional manner towards their work, the work of fellow artists, and respecting the instructor, the studio and the discipline. Students will demonstrate professionalism by the following:

- Meeting course attendance requirements.
- Following directions for each assignment.
- Having all supplies needed for each assignment.
- Completing projects within the given time frame.
- Adopting a professional attitude towards oneself and the class community.
- Respecting posted studio safety rules.
- Cleaning and helping with studio organization and maintenance.
- Critique contribution and performance.
- Not using a cell phone or other electronic device in the classroom without prior consent from the instructor.
- Scheduling time with the professor to clarify concepts or discuss course material outside of class time.
- No eating or smoking in the studio; water is the only beverage allowed in the studio.
- Cleaning up all spaces and materials at the end of class, and returning furniture to its designated location in the room.

Note: Failure to adhere to Studio Policy or creating other hazards in the studio may result in the student's removal from the course.

Attendance Policy:

Attendance and participation are crucial to understanding concepts, completing projects, and interacting with fellow artists. For students to successfully complete their college work, regular class attendance is necessary, and students are expected to attend all sessions of classes in which they are enrolled (Los Rios Regulation R-2222).

All students who remain enrolled in a class after the last day to withdraw (see the [Academic Calendar](#)) will be issued a letter grade for the course. If a student has stopped attending but not dropped the class, the student may receive an F grade for the course on their permanent record. Exception to this policy involves completion of the Cosumnes River College Student Petition, with appropriate signatures and documentation of extenuating circumstances.

Excessive Absences: Students are expected to attend all sessions of the class in which they are enrolled. Any student with excessive absences may be dropped from class (Title 5, Section 58004). Per Los Rios Regulation R-2222, a student may be dropped from any class when that student's absences exceed six percent (6%) of the total hours of class time. Instructors shall state in each course syllabus what constitutes excessive absences for that course.

Non-Attendance at First Class

Per Los Rios Regulation R-2222, students who fail to attend the first session of a class may be dropped by the instructor.

***STUDENTS ARE NOT ALLOWED TO MAKE UP ABSENCES-Class tardiness, leaving early, break tardiness, and being unprepared to work (including not having needed materials) will be counted as an absence. All absences are counted, no excused absences will be accepted.**

Student will be dropped once 5 absences are reached.

Grading Procedures and Policy:

Grading expectations and grades earned will be evaluated on an assignment rubric. Description of grades (FROM CRC CATALOG): A (excellent), B (good), C (satisfactory), D (passing (not satisfactory)), F (failure).

Turning in all assignments and meeting minimum requirements does not automatically result in the semester grade of an "A". An "A" represents "excellent", demonstrating the highest-level work which is the combination of meeting all requirements with excellent visual communication, a unique creative vision and superb craftsmanship and college-level presentation. Students are graded on the degree to which they meet learning outcomes, in addition to the amount of time and effort put forth in the course.

90% OF THE FINAL GRADE:

Assignments, in class and outside of class:

- All in-class and many outside of class assignments receive a letter grade. The work should be well structured, finely nuanced, thoughtful, neatly presented and they should demonstrate technical facility and attention to the formal elements of drawing. As the semester progresses, the grading of the drawings will measure the ability to apply a larger range of formal elements and techniques, and greater technical skill. Class assignments must be completed within the specified time frame.
- Semester graded assignments are each: 20 pts.
- Written 2-page paper: 10 pts.
- Mid-Term assignment: 50 pts.
- Final assignment (due the last day of the course): 100 pts.

Missing assignment or exercise:

- Any missing letter/point graded assignment or exercise will be marked down 1pt for every day that it is late. Students are expected to submit ALL assignments, class assignments and class exercises, **including those for missed classes**, on the day they are due. It is the responsibility of the student to talk to the instructor about the possibility of makeup work for missed classes.

Assignment Revision:

- Any assignment or exercise can be recreated or revised and submitted for a grade revision. The original assignment must be photographed and submitted along with the new assignment. Prior discussion with the instructor about a revised assignment is mandatory. You cannot makeup deducted late submission points.

Professionalism & participation: 32 pts.

Includes active participation in class discussions and during critiques, timely completion of all assignments, attendance/punctuality/leaving early/extended breaks, and respect for the art studio policies and for the safety of the community, respect for others, having needed supplies.

- The grade for class participation measures both how actively the student participates in the class, class discussions and critiques, as well as the level of analytical skills. Lack of regular participation in the course lowers the grade for class participation.
- Every class period attended will receive 1 participation points for a total of 32 pts.

Special Accommodations:

Disabled Student Programs & Services (DSP&S) provides equal educational opportunity for students with physical, psychological, or learning disabilities. Students with disabilities are encouraged to lead active and independent lives by participating in all college programs. Counseling, support services, and academic accommodations are provided to students who are eligible for the program. It is the student's responsibility to contact the instructor in a timely manner to arrange appropriate accommodations. If you have a documented disability, including a specific learning disability, please notify the instructor to discuss possible accommodation needs, if so desired.

All accommodations must be arranged through the DSP&S. All information will be kept confidential.

Visit http://www.crc.losrios.edu/Student_Services/DSPS (Links to an external site.) for more detailed information

Academic Honesty:

CRC recognizes the seriousness of plagiarism, which is defined as turning in someone else's work and calling it your own. At CRC plagiarism is treated as a dishonest action, an issue of dishonorable behavior. In addition, students are expected to avoid unintentional plagiarism, which means including in your own work and passing off as your own writing, phrases, sentences, paragraphs, ideas, or in our case images or more, that are only slightly changed from the original source. Allowing someone else to create artwork for you is also plagiarism. Penalties for plagiarism, per CRC's Violations of the Student Code of Conduct, can be severe. It is the student's responsibility to read and understand CRC's definition of plagiarism and cheating as found online at: http://www.crc.losrios.edu/College_Catalog/General_Information/Student_Behavior_and_Academic_Integrity.htm (Links to an external site.) In addition, the student should be familiar with CRC's Honor Code dealing with honesty, fairness, respect and responsibility. This information is also found at the above online link.

LRCCD NON-DISCRIMINATION POLICY

The Los Rios Community College District, in compliance with all pertinent Titles and Sections of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, the Educational Amendments of 1972, the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, Americans with Disabilities Act, and all other applicable federal, state and local laws, does not discriminate on the basis of race, color, marital status, religion, sexual preference, national origin, sex, age over forty, handicap or Vietnam-era veteran status, physical or mental disability, nor shall any students be discriminated against for conversing in a language other than English, in any of its functions or activities, including employment, educational programs and services, admissions and financial aid.

The District further complies with those federal and state laws and the regulations of the Board of Governors of the California Community Colleges which prohibit sexual harassment.

Such non-discrimination policies extend to all the functions and activities of the Los Rios Community College District including employment and employment selection, educational programs, services, admissions and financial aid.

Tentative Nature of the Syllabus:

If necessary, this syllabus and its contents are subject to revision; students are responsible for any changes or modifications to the syllabus that are distributed in class.

Emergency Preparedness: To report an emergency or suspicious activity, contact the **CRC Campus Police** by phone **(916) 558-2221**, then **press zero**, at the nearest emergency call box, or the Operations & Public Safety (OPS) building, north of the Learning Resource Center. There are blue light emergency phones located throughout campus that connect you directly to Los Rios Police Dispatch. Use these phones to call police in an emergency or if you need an officer dispatched to your location. In the event of an evacuation, follow the evacuation signage throughout the building to the designated safe refuge area where you will receive further instruction from Public Safety.

The **Health Center** can be reached at HealthAndWellness@crc.losrios.edu, **(916) 691-7584**, Operations and Public Safety, OPS 126. After hours, call Campus Safety for assistance and in an emergency.

Email Communication: At times I will communicate with the entire class using campus email systems and Canvas, so it is essential that you regularly check your CRC email address or forward your CRC account email to your preferred email address.

Additional Studio Notes:

- Fall Semester: August 23-December 18
- Dates to note:
 - Sept. 6: Last day to drop classes and qualify for a tuition
 - Sept. 8: Last day to drop classes without a notation on your record
 - Nov. 19: Last day to withdraw from classes with a "W" on your transcript
 - Dec. 13-19th Final Exams
- Final Exam: Monday, December 15, 8:00-10:00am
- Holidays:
 - Sept. 1st- Labor Day
 - Nov. 11th-Veterans Day
 - November 27-30th Thanksgiving Recess
- Week 15 is the last week that assignments or exercises will be accepted for a grade. Any assignment for the course not submitted by this date receives a failing grade. (Final assignment does not apply, due the last day of the semester)
- Work submitted after the course ends will not be accepted.
- Artwork must be removed from the studio by the last day of the semester.
- Any unclaimed artwork or supplies left in the studio will be destroyed on the last day of the semester.
- Please do not call the department to report routine absences.
- Break: There will be no scheduled break provided during each class period. Breaks are taken at the discretion of the student and should not be taken during lecture or while the instructor is speaking.
- If you need additional time to complete a test or if you require special accommodations, you must notify the instructor in a timely manner. Otherwise, you will be expected to adhere to the information included on this course syllabus.
- After 5 absences YOU WILL BE DROPPED FROM THE COURSE.